



SAFE

Washing your hands removes germs that can make you sick. Cleaning the counter helps stop germs from spreading to your food. This way, your sandwich stays safe to eat.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



NOT SAFE

Mold can grow roots deep inside the jam, not just on the fuzzy part you see. These molds might make you sick, so it's best to throw the jam away if you see mold.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



IT DEPENDS

Potato salad should not be left out too long because warm temperatures make bacteria grow fast. If it was out for more than 2 hours or your home is very warm, it's safer to throw it away. If it was less time and feels cool, it might still be safe.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



SAFE

This is safe because the peaches were fresh, clean, and packed in jars with new lids. The jars were boiled in a water bath canner, which cooks the fruit enough to keep germs away and seal the jars properly.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



NOT SAFE

Even if the jar lid is sealed, mold means tiny germs grew inside and the jam is spoiled. Eating moldy jam can make you sick, so it's not safe. Always throw away jams with mold.

Source: Troubleshooting canning acid foods



IT DEPENDS

Leaving fruit out before canning can let germs grow. If the jam smells bad or the lid is still popped up after cooking, it's not safe to eat. But if it smells fresh, has no mold, and the jar is properly processed and sealed, it might be okay. When in doubt, throw it out!

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



SAFE

This salsa is safe because you followed a tested recipe that has enough acid to stop bad germs from growing. Using bottled lemon juice and cooking it in a boiling water canner makes sure the salsa stays safe to eat.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



NOT SAFE

The popped lid and bad smell are signs that the tomatoes went bad. This can happen if the jar wasn't sealed right or if bad germs grew inside. Never eat canned food if the lid pops up, it smells bad, or looks funny.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



IT DEPENDS

Salsa safety depends on having enough acid like vinegar or lemon juice. If there's not enough acid, harmful germs can grow. To know if it's safe, you need to follow a tested recipe or keep the salsa in the fridge or freezer instead.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



SAFE

Because green beans are low acid, they must be processed in a pressure canner to reach a high enough temperature that kills harmful bacteria. When canned this way and sealed tight, the food is safe to eat. Pressure canning protects us from dangerous germs like botulism that can grow in low acid foods if not heated enough.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game



NOT SAFE

When the lid pops up, it means the jar did not seal properly and bad germs could have grown inside. These germs can make the food unsafe even if it looks or smells okay. It's best to throw the jar away to stay safe.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game



IT DEPENDS

Low acid foods need to be kept hot or refrigerated after opening because bacteria can grow if left out too long. Even if the jar sealed initially, if it smells funny or shows mold, it is not safe. But if it smells fresh and has no mold, cooking it again can make it safe.

Source: PNW 450 Canning smoked fish at home



SAFE

When you use real vinegar with enough sourness and keep everything clean, the pickles stay safe to eat. The vinegar stops bad germs from growing. It's important to not use homemade vinegar and to use fresh vegetables and a clean jar.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



NOT SAFE

If the jar lid is popped up and the pickles smell bad or look moldy or cloudy, this means bad bacteria or germs have grown. It is unsafe to eat, and you should throw it away to not get sick.

Source: UC David Safely fermented fruit and vegetable



IT DEPENDS

Sometimes bubbling means the pickles are fermenting safely, making good acid to protect them. But if the jar wasn't clean, or the lid popped open a lot, or the smell is bad, it might be dangerous. Check if it smells nice and sour and has no mold. If it smells bad or looks fuzzy, it's not safe.

Source: UC David Safely fermented fruit and vegetable



SAFE

When jam jars are boiled for the proper time, sealed tightly, and look clear without mold or bubbles, they are safe to eat. The popping lid shows a good vacuum seal that keeps air and germs out. Always check the smell and look to make sure nothing is wrong before eating.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



NOT SAFE

If you see fuzzy mold or green spots on jelly, or the jelly smells bad or sour, it means it can be dangerous to eat. Also, if the lid is popped up, it shows no seal, and germs can spoil the jelly. Always throw away jelly with mold or off smells.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



IT DEPENDS

When jam is left out too long, it can grow germs, especially if the lid seal is broken. But if it looks clear, smells sweet and fresh, and there is no fuzzy mold, it might still be okay for a short time. Use your nose and eyes to decide, but when in doubt, don't eat it.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



SAFE

When frozen food is kept at the right cold temperature and stays frozen, it stops germs from growing. The blueberries stay safe to eat if they never thaw before you take them out. Keeping the freezer cold and not opening it too much helps keep the food good and safe.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



NOT SAFE

When canned food freezes and the can lid bulges or seams break, it means germs might have grown inside and made the food bad. So it's best to throw it away to keep from getting sick because bulging cans mean danger.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



IT DEPENDS

If a jar lid pops up after freezing, the seal might be broken, which lets air in and germs can grow. But if the jam still smells sweet, looks good, and isn't moldy, it can be eaten. If it smells bad or has mold, it's not safe and should be thrown away.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



SAFE

Drying apples until they are leathery means most water is gone, so bad germs can't grow. Keeping them in a clean, airtight place stops new germs from getting on them. This way, your dried apples stay safe to eat!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



NOT SAFE

A bad smell and sticky, slimy fish means germs might be growing. If fish smells funny or looks slimy, it can make you sick. It's best to throw it away instead of eating it.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



IT DEPENDS

Jerky is safe when it is dried well and stored in a cool, dry place. But if it smells bad or looks moldy, it can make you sick. Watch for bad smells or fuzzy spots-that's when it's not safe.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely